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Gaming as a career? You must be kidding! Games are what you come back to after a hard day's mind numbing work at the office. And is it not against the law to have to game for your daily bread? Not review a game, not code for a game—just play it?

The Current Global Scene

It is in the West, Korea and Japan that video gaming has come out of living rooms and basements and has been elevated into any other competitive sport like football or cricket. Teams—also called clans—made up of hardcore gamers comfortable in a particular genre like FPS, RPG or racing games compete in gaming conventions. Other pro gamers play individually. Ultimately whether a gamer is playing as an individual or as a team depends on the type of game.

As gamers started playing professionally gaming leagues have been established to con-

duct tournaments in the model of bodies like FIFA or ICC.

However unlike sports like soccer and cricket there is no single global body to regulate gaming. Some countries have competing leagues while others have one at the national level. Some active leagues are MLG (North America), Pro Gaming League (Canada), Championship Gaming Series, World Cyber Games (South Korea).

Most of these leagues organise tournaments sponsored by virtually all the vendors that make game oriented hardware, from mouse to motherboards to graphic cards to cooler cases. Then there are also vendor-backed gaming leagues like Dell's College Gaming League, launched last month and open to all university students.

In order to broaden the base of gaming even more, many leagues are signing up with TV channels and broadcasting matches live. ESPN, for example, has entered an extensive tie-up with MLG to cover all gaming events organ-

Thought gaming was just an idle pastime? How would you like to make money at it? Can you?

